

Reflecting on my AI Learning Experience | *Nikaila Bell* | ITLS 6250

I have grown a large interest in AI over the past 3 years as I took courses where our teachers encouraged us to use it to our advantage to learn and support our work. I have always been passionate about my own ideas and the good work I can do, but it has changed the game to use AI to help make my work even better. I used to spend hours to complete every one of my assignments as I held myself to a high standard, even higher than our professors. But sometimes I still didn't have enough time to really get my work to where I wanted it, with all that I had on my plate. Now, with the support of AI, it helps me with all the time-consuming setup and busywork and allows me to use all my time to create and iterate until I love my final result.

It took the stress off, so I didn't have to worry about not having enough time or only being able to do the bare minimum, but to be able to accomplish everything I sought out to. My husband is a huge tech nerd, and over the past 2 years he has taught me all he knows about AI and the new things coming out, and all I need to know about how it has come to be and where it's going. It inspires me to have a tool that can make my dream projects come true. I feel like I can truly let my talents and ideas shine when I am capable of doing them how I want. AI teaches me daily. I am often curious and learn about many things, including life skills, health, tech, etc. I know that there are some scary things about AI, and that many people create AI slop, but I think if we use it wisely and let it add to our skills and work, and use it to learn consistently, we can become better ourselves. This class taught me this through using AI in ways I had never experienced.

I think I will use AI in my future job application to rapidly create wireframes and test the accessibility of my designs. I've learned from this class that the real value in the future will be in curation and user experience. It won't be about who can make the most learning materials, but who can design the most intuitive, accessible, and human-centered interfaces for learners to interact with. I have also learned that though AI does threaten some jobs, human-centered design cannot be replaced, and having AI expertise will only help me in my future occupational role. AI is not going away, and thus it is important to take advantage and learn all you can so that you can have the skills to operate it well within your job and be an asset to the team.

As I move forward in my instructional technology and learning sciences coursework, I take with me a profound shift in perspective. AI is not a replacement for human intuition, but a powerful design co-pilot. The real challenge of the future won't be generating educational content, but designing accessible, intuitive platforms that actually help students learn.